Mihai Culea

Software Engineer — Full Stack

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Summary

Software Engineer with commercial experience in PHP and JavaScript, building business-critical systems for warehouse, logistics, and hospitality operations. Comfortable owning features end to end across backend services, relational databases, and modern JavaScript frontends (Vue, React).

Background in internal tools, third-party integrations, and a large multi-service PHP/JavaScript platform of my own. Focused on pragmatic, maintainable solutions and close collaboration with the people who use what I build.

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** JavaScript, PHP, Python, Java
- **Frontend / Applications:** Vue.js, Pinia, React, React Native, Next.js, Electron, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, HTML, CSS, jQuery
- **Backend / APIs:** Node.js, Express, REST API, Socket.IO, third-party system integrations (TCP/IP sockets, custom messaging protocols), Laravel, CodeIgniter
- **Databases:** MySQL, SQL, MongoDB, Firebase, Supabase
- **Practices:** Object-Oriented Programming, Agile/Scrum, Git version control, code review, production release management, technical support and documentation
- **Cloud / Tooling:** Apache, Caddy, SSL/TLS certificate configuration, Fly.io, Vercel, Firebase, Netlify, Docker (familiar), GitHub Actions, Stripe, Google APIs, VS Code

Professional Experience

Systems Developer — Keymas Ltd *September 2024 – Present, Birmingham (Hybrid)*

- Lead the development and delivery of a new version of the company's core software, coordinating technical work across development, testing, deployment, and release.
- Design and develop new features for business-critical warehouse and logistics software, working across PHP and Vue.js/JavaScript.
- Build and maintain third-party system integrations using TCP/IP socket interfaces and custom messaging protocols.
- Refactor legacy PHP and JavaScript codebases to improve maintainability, structure, and performance.
- Build internal tools and dashboards to improve operational visibility for the business.
- Designed and developed a honeypot system to monitor unsolicited traffic, identify suspicious activity, log offending IP addresses, and automatically block unwanted traffic.

Junior Support Developer — Keymas Ltd *February 2024 – September 2024, Birmingham (Hybrid)*

- Provided 1st and 2nd line support, working with colleagues and third-party providers to deliver fixes and functionality changes in code and configuration.
- Managed production releases, coordinating safe transitions from development to live systems.
- Conducted on-site customer visits for support and project implementation, and maintained support documentation.

Freelance Software Developer — CCWorcester *June 2023 – July 2024, Worcester*

- Delivered various web projects and tasks for clients sourced through Freelancer.com and Fiverr.com.
- Integrated third-party APIs and payment services (Stripe, Google Maps) with a focus on securing client data.

- Adapted to each client's required tech stack, some of which included PHP, React, Node.js, and MongoDB/SQL/Firebase databases as needed.

Web Developer (Volunteer) — 10zyme *January 2024 – June 2024, Remote*

- Contributed front-end and back-end development across a React Native mobile app and a Next.js web platform.
- Implemented and tested subscription and payment access features integrated with Stripe.
- Managed project work via GitHub in line with team standards and release processes.

Project Spotlight: Fimiar EPOS *Personal project, January 2025 – Present |* *https://demo.fimiar.co.uk/*

A hospitality point-of-sale platform designed and built end to end as a multi-service system, covering the order-to-payment lifecycle for restaurant and bar venues.

- Built a Node.js/Express REST API backend with MySQL and Socket.IO for real-time order and till updates.
- Designed and built a CodeIgniter 4 (PHP) service for cross-venue customer accounts, loyalty, coupons, and bookings. Venues push data to it asynchronously, so it never blocks order placement.
- Developed a staff-facing till (Electron, Vue 3, Pinia, Tailwind), a lightweight web/mobile till, and a back-office analytics dashboard (Vue 3, ApexCharts). All three share one stack, API conventions, and optional request/response payload encryption.
- Built a customer-facing QR ordering web app (Vue 3) for table-side ordering.
- Implemented table reservation and booking management with a visual timetable, plus a digital voucher/coupon system.
- Wrote a local Windows hardware bridge (Node/Express, packaged to a standalone .exe) that connects receipt printers and cash drawers to the till over the local network and COM ports.
- Designed a licensing scheme based on bcrypt-hashed expiry dates, with an offline key-generator tool for issuing licences.
- Deployed the backend to private cloud server and configured a Caddy reverse proxy to route API, till, and office traffic on a custom domain.

Till interface - *https://demo.fimiar.co.uk/app/* *https://demo.fimiar.co.uk/mini/*
Test key: pc_main_8ea5dfde-b0b4-e5e3-3956-cf481a9453b4
Back office - *https://demo.fimiar.co.uk/office/*
Demo video - *https://youtu.be/hbuLIfZNyEI*

Customer QR - *https://qr.fimiar.co.uk/blackthorn-hospitality-group/the-tipsy-badger-1*
Booking Manager - *https://qr.fimiar.co.uk/management/blackthorn-hospitality-group/the-tipsy-badger-1*
Demo video - *https://youtu.be/lYlcMLOGhjU*

Full portfolio: https://mihaiculea.web.app/

Education

- **BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 1:1** — Solent University, February 2021 – September 2023
- **Cisco CCNA Certification** — June 2021
- **Grigore Cerchez** Technological College, September 2006 – June 2010

Additional Experience

Various Head Chef and hospitality management roles across the UK from April 2011 to December 2023, providing direct, hands-on knowledge of the hospitality operations that the Fimiar EPOS platform is designed to support.

Interests

Aerial/drone videography; growing the Fimiar EPOS project into a commercial product; technical training via LinkedIn Skill Assessments.